Project Overview

Introduction

1. Background

IT procurement is responsible for supplying employees with the hardware they need to do their jobs. Standard laptops are among the most frequently requested items, and every laptop that arrives must be configured before it can be handed over to the user. When the step between an approved request and the start of configuration depends on someone remembering to raise a task, delays and missed follow-ups become common.

ServiceNow is a cloud platform used to manage IT services, requests and workflows. **Flow Designer** is its low-code automation tool: a flow is built from a *trigger* that starts it and one or more *actions* that carry out the work, so routine processes can be automated without writing scripts.

2. About the Project

This project, **Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**, uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate the configuration step of the standard laptop order process. When a Standard Laptop is requested through the Service Catalog and the request is approved, a Catalog Task is generated automatically and assigned to the Hardware group, so the team knows immediately that a laptop needs to be configured.

The result is a process that requires no manual task creation, reduces the chance of oversight and shortens the time a user waits for a ready-to-use laptop.

3. Key Components

Component	Name / Value	Role in the solution
Flow	Standard Laptop task	The automation that runs when a Standard Laptop request is placed.
Trigger	Service Catalog	Starts the flow when a service catalog request is submitted.
Action	Create Catalog Task	Generates a Catalog Task [sc_task] for the requested item.
Catalog item	Standard Laptop (Hardware category)	The item users order from the Service Catalog.
Assignment group	Hardware	The team responsible for configuring the laptop.

Component	Name / Value	Role in the solution
Run as	System User	Ensures the flow executes with the permissions it needs.

4. Scope

In scope

- Creating the **Standard Laptop task** flow in Flow Designer.
- Assigning the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item through the Process Engine tab.
- Placing an order, approving the request and verifying the generated Catalog Task.

Out of scope

- Purchasing the physical device from vendors.
- Automation for other catalog items.
- Additional features such as email notifications or SLA tracking, which can be added in future enhancements.

5. Process Overview

1. The user orders the **Standard Laptop** from the Service Catalog.
2. A request is created and sent to the approver.
3. The approver approves the request.
4. The flow creates a Catalog Task with the short description *Laptop needs to Configured*.
5. The task is assigned to the **Hardware** group.
6. The Hardware team configures the laptop and closes the task.

6. Project Milestones

Milestone	Activity	Outcome
1. Flow	Create the flow with a Service Catalog trigger and a Create Catalog Task action.	An active flow named Standard Laptop task.
2. Flow assignment	Attach the flow to the Standard Laptop catalog item.	The catalog item runs the flow whenever it is ordered.
3. Service Catalog	Place an order, approve the request and check the catalog task.	A Catalog Task assigned to the Hardware group is generated automatically.

7. Tools and Technologies

- ServiceNow platform
- Flow Designer (Process Automation)

- Service Catalog and Maintain Items
- Catalog Tasks and Approvals

8. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Interest in the project
End users	Receive a configured laptop sooner after their request is approved.
IT procurement team	Handle standard laptop orders without manual task creation.
Hardware team	Receive clearly described configuration tasks assigned directly to the team.

9. Expected Benefits

- **Faster configuration:** the task exists as soon as the request is approved.
- **Fewer errors:** every task is created with the same short description and assignment group.
- **Less manual work:** the procurement team no longer creates or assigns tasks by hand.
- **Better use of resources:** configuration work is routed straight to the Hardware group.
- **Better user experience:** users wait less and the process is consistent every time.

10. Structure of the Documentation

The project documentation is organised into the Problem Statement, the User Story and the Project Objective, followed by step-by-step guides for each of the three milestones: Flow, Flow Assignment and Service Catalog. Each milestone guide includes screenshots of the ServiceNow screens involved.